

Maneesh Sharma,
Country Manager,
GitHub India

GitHub's India plans

Following the launch of GitHub operations in India, we spoke to Maneesh Sharma, Country Manager, GitHub India to know more about their plans.

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Q First question, why India?

Maneesh: Over the last few years, we've had a tremendous response, already over 50 million developers are on GitHub. I always get excited to share that India is the third largest community. There is a phenomenal level of digital transformation that is happening in the Indian ecosystem. Despite us (Indians) having the third largest community on GitHub, it is very important for us to be closer to the community, as well as customers, to take their feedback, and look at how we can serve them better. That was the main objective behind us looking at how we can get closer to the community here in India. The other thing that we do and are very passionate about, is education. That's also one of the main reasons for us, looking at how we can help all students in India to adapt to software

development, and accelerate this whole cycle. The growth of the contribution from India on GitHub has been phenomenal. We actually come out with our Octoverse Report every November, and the last one that we did showed that India grew by more than 22 percent. There has been growth in contributions to the open source community as well. It is just a signal that apart from consuming a lot of open source code, the software developers in India are starting to contribute back into the ecosystem. This is something that I really want to drive here in India, and come up with a lot of open source projects from India.

Q What is different about India as a market?

Maneesh: One reason is definitely the large size of the developer pool itself. We have millions of software developers sitting in large organisations, and graduating from colleges every year. And even from the education perspective, there are many that are starting to learn software development not only in college but right from sixth grade onwards. So the culture of having software development embedded into careers and education is just a great opportunity. Second reason is given how India has evolved as a market and an economy, digital first and mobile first is a way of leapfrogging many of the traditional issues that have been existing,

whether it is market inefficiencies or infrastructure issues. Given that we are in India, it is a great opportunity to be a part of this transformation.

Q What do you have to offer for students?

Maneesh: We have what we call as the student developer pack. Any student can apply and get access to a host of software and technologies from GitHub, as well as our partners. The value is about a 200,000 dollar pack, with access to multiple software like different cloud providers, so that includes credits for AWS, Azure, and many other players.

The second thing that we provide is what is called as a GitHub classroom for colleges and universities. It is a specific product that we have created for educational institutes, to help them teach coding. This specific tool helps teachers and professors teach coding to their students.

The GitHub platform is provided to educational institutes for free. We also have a program called GitHub campus experts. Think of them as brand ambassadors. We identify somebody to become a GitHub campus expert. They go out and represent GitHub in the community.

Q Can we expect more integrations with Microsoft products after the acquisition?

Maneesh: The reason GitHub has grown to that 50 million mark is because of the openness of the platform. While Microsoft and AWS are large players, we have integrations for even open source companies like Jenkins, as well as popular tools such as Jira or Slack. So all of these integrations are available in the Marketplace. In fact if any developer goes into the Marketplace, they will see that there are virtually thousands and thousands of integrations, across platforms that are available, including Microsoft. The openness of the platform is something that is sacrosanct for GitHub. It is not as if the GitHub platform will only work with Microsoft technologies. That was never the case and that will not happen. Developer's choice is everything. Nobody wants to be tied down to a specific tool or technology or language. They are always looking to experiment, and as long as we provide that flexibility, we will continue to be very relevant for what developers want in the future as well. 